GOSIM

GOSIM Shenzhen 2026

Building a Knowledge-Work Harness

From Coding Agents to Executable Strategy

Igor Schwarzmann · Agentic AI Summit · GOSIM Shenzhen 2026



Igor Schwarzmann, Berlin

Advisory and strategy for twenty years, across the US, Europe and Asia. AI strategy & transformation since 2020.

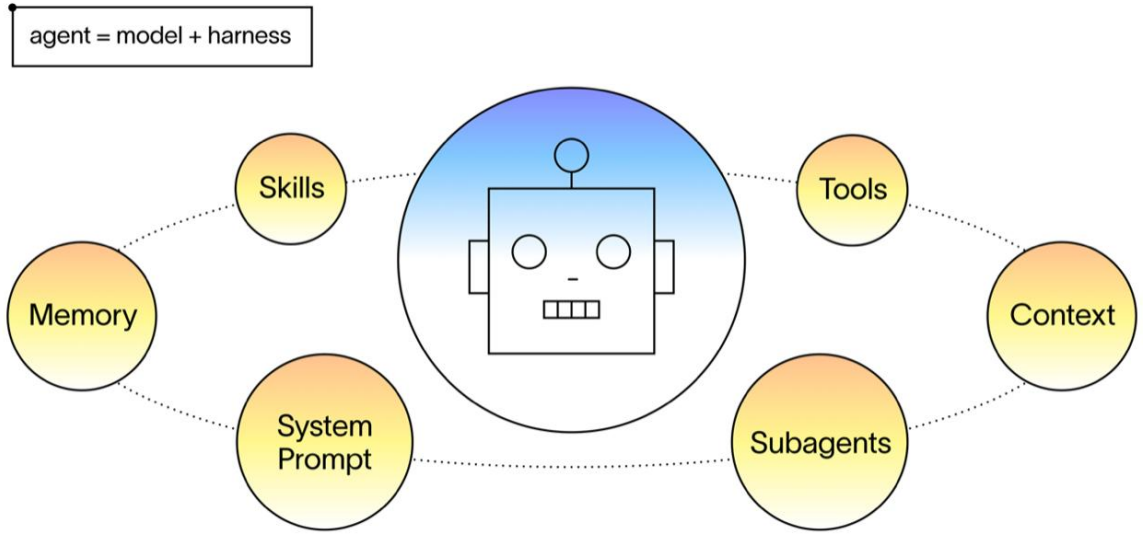
Co-founder of the Make It So Program, started in August 2026 with Chiba Institute of Technology (Tokyo) and Flinders University (Adelaide).



What is a harness?

“agent = model + harness.

The **harness** is the scaffolding around the model that connects it to the real world.”



Sydney Runkle, LangChain, How to Build a Custom Agent Harness

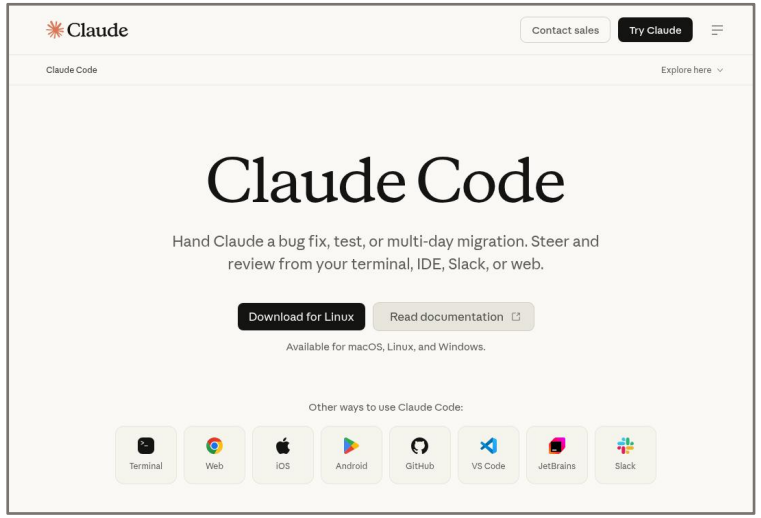


“We shape our buildings and afterwards our buildings shape us.”

Winston Churchill

Picking your harness says a lot about how you want to work. Even if you do not realise it.

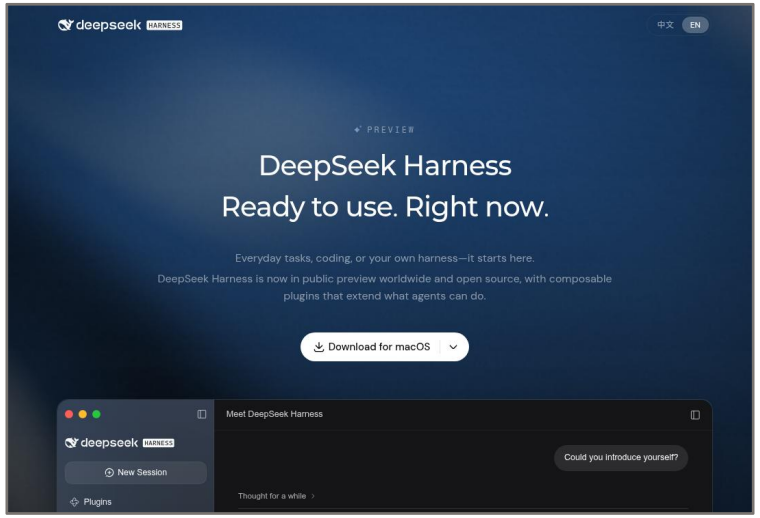
Claude Code



Hand it the work, then steer and review.

"Anthropic knows best."

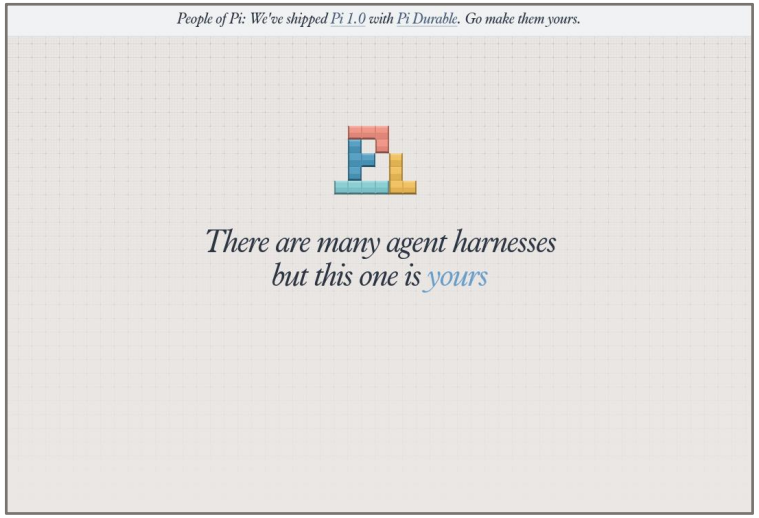
DeepSeek Harness



Everything is a plugin, models included.

A lab shipped it. You can shape it.

Pi

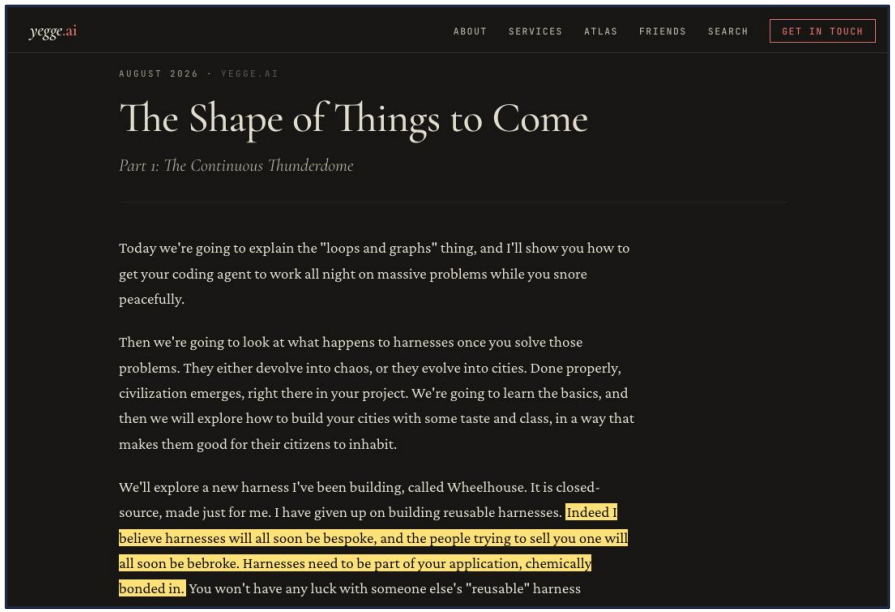


Primitives, not features.

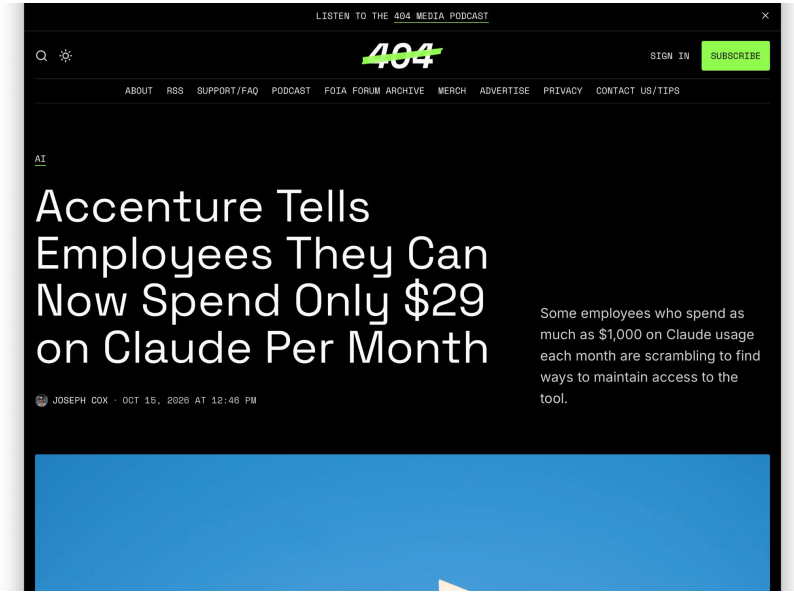
The harness is yours to build.

Three opinions about how work should run.

Meanwhile in the real world of coding vs. knowledge work



vs.



“Harnesses will all soon be bespoke.”

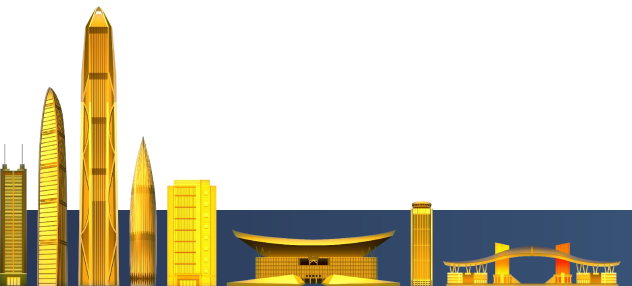
Steve Yegge, The Shape of Things to Come, August 2026

Knowledge work doesn’t see the bottom line gains that coding does …

For knowledge work, AI is not an engineering problem but a management problem

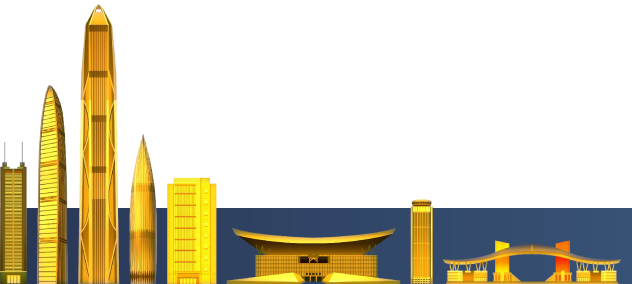
> **“These gains are not being captured by companies.”**
>
> Ethan Mollick, One Useful Thing

> **“This change will not happen bottom-up.”**
>
> Gabriele Rosani and Elisa Farri, Harvard Business Review

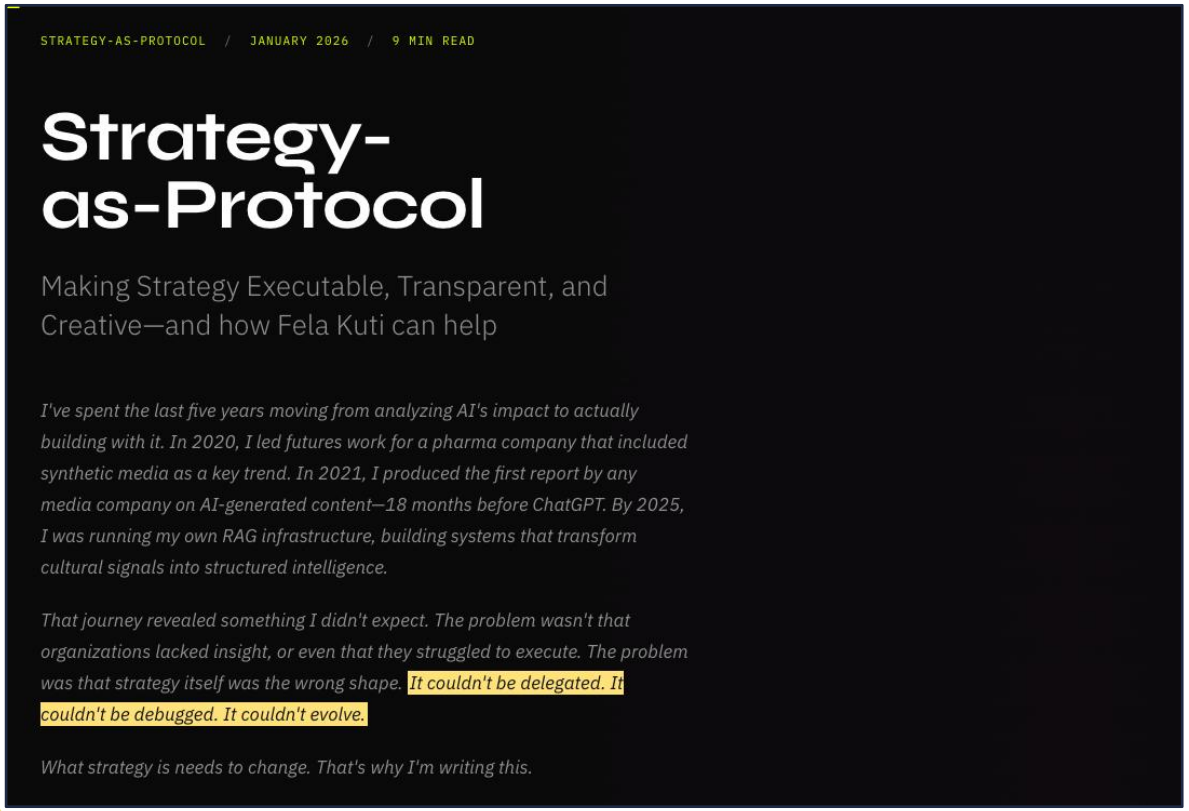


When everyone has their own setup, the gains stay with individuals

What you can observe	What it costs
Everyone has their own setup	Tools and methods differ from person to person
What works stays with whoever found it	Some people and teams get faster. The organization does not
AI is used alone, rarely together	Meetings, reviews and planning run as they did before
Nobody decides what is worth sharing	The same thing gets built several times
Access rules decide what a team can build	They were set for other reasons, and management rarely owns them



My answer: Strategy as protocol



STRATEGY-AS-PROTOCOL / JANUARY 2026 / 9 MIN READ

Strategy-as-Protocol

Making Strategy Executable, Transparent, and Creative—and how Fela Kuti can help

I've spent the last five years moving from analyzing AI's impact to actually building with it. In 2020, I led futures work for a pharma company that included synthetic media as a key trend. In 2021, I produced the first report by any media company on AI-generated content—18 months before ChatGPT. By 2025, I was running my own RAG infrastructure, building systems that transform cultural signals into structured intelligence.

That journey revealed something I didn't expect. The problem wasn't that organizations lacked insight, or even that they struggled to execute. The problem was that strategy itself was the wrong shape. It couldn't be delegated. It couldn't be debugged. It couldn't evolve.

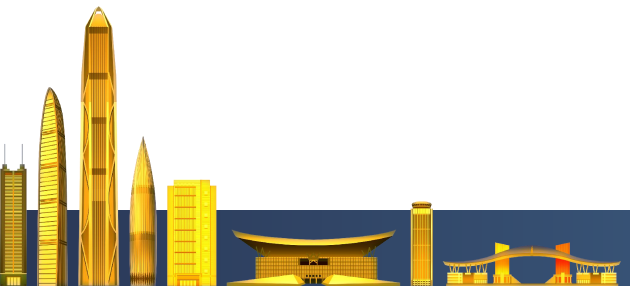
What strategy is needs to change. That's why I'm writing this.

The firm's strategy as plain-text rules: readable by people, executable by machines.

Published January 2026.
igorschwarzmann.com/strategyasprotocol

Coding has agreed protocols. Knowledge work has … “culture”?

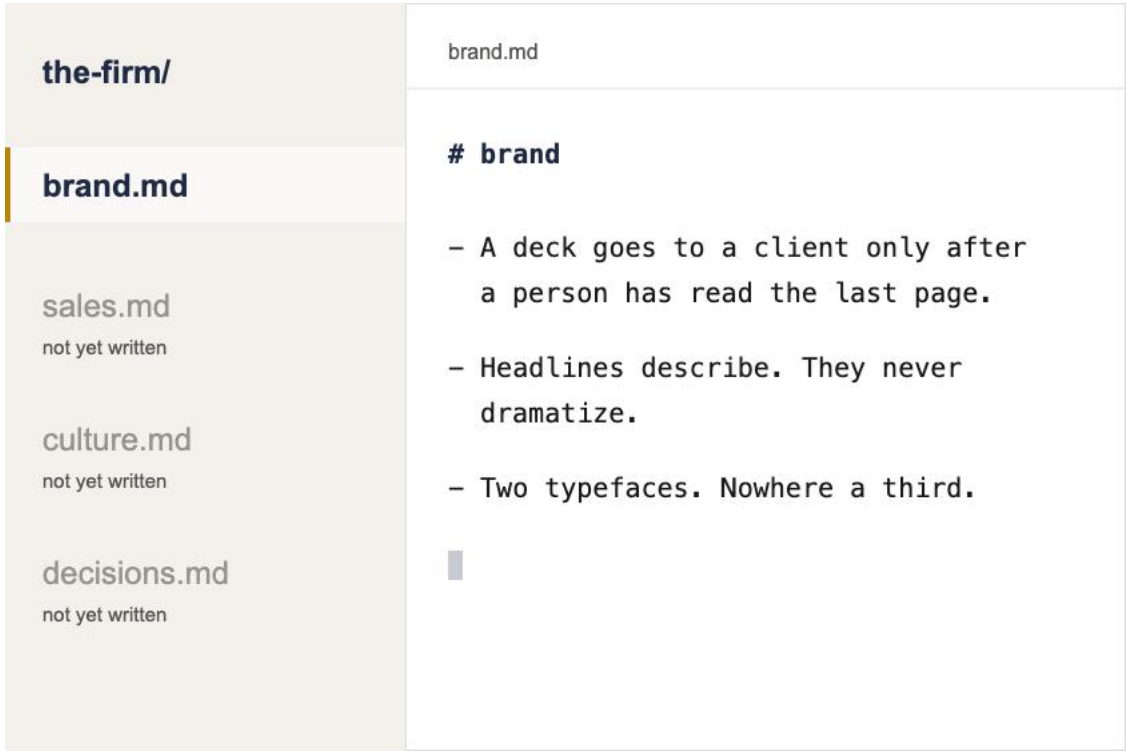
Coding	Knowledge work
git: a history of every change	the last version someone emailed
tests: the artifact says whether it works	someone reads it and decides
types and compiler: the shape is enforced	a template, when it is followed
lint: style enforced at no cost	a brand guideline nobody opens
the pull request: review as a protocol	a meeting



You can’t delegate what you can’t articulate

Write down how you actually work.

Write it knowing what the machine can do.



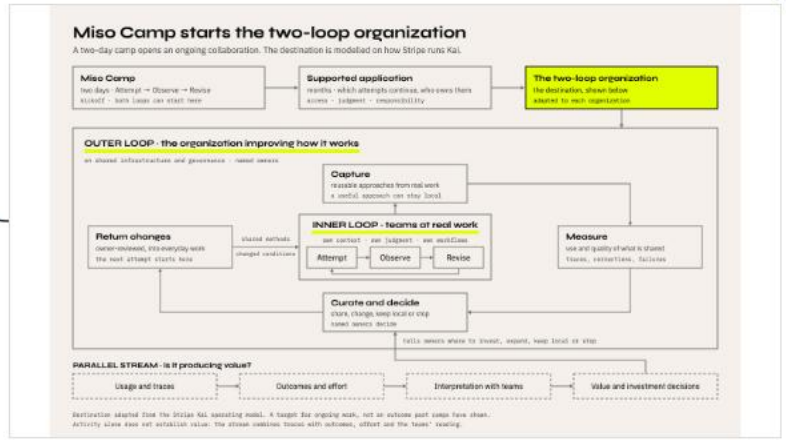
One design file powers everything I publish

DESIGN.md

```
colors: volt, signal, shift
typography: Syne, IBM Plex
spacing: xs sm md lg
voice: observational, plain
modes: personal, essay, deck
motion: enter, hold, exit
```

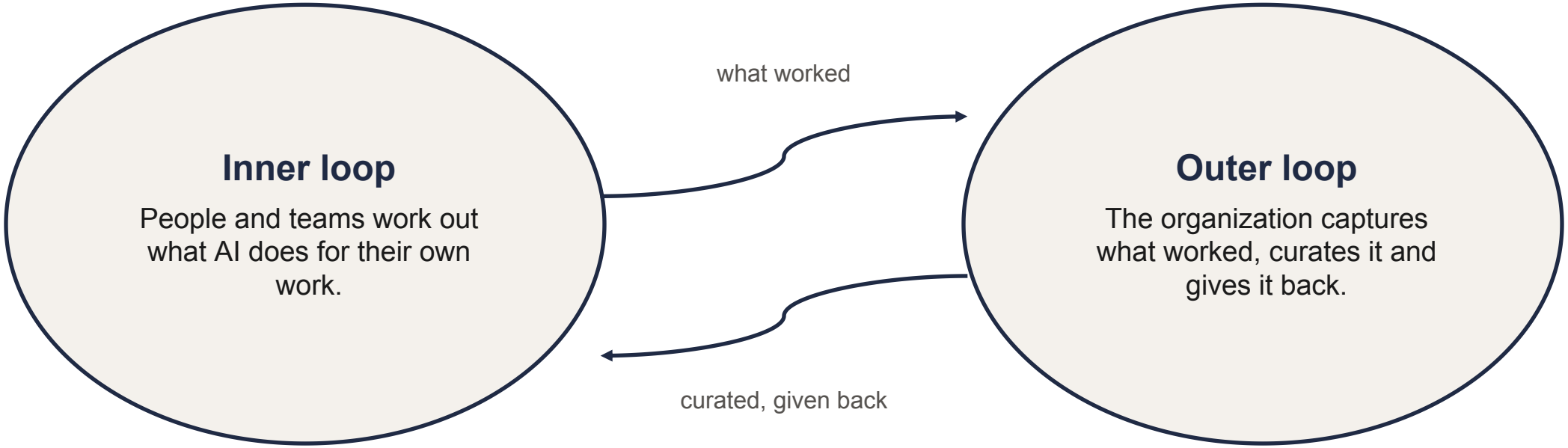






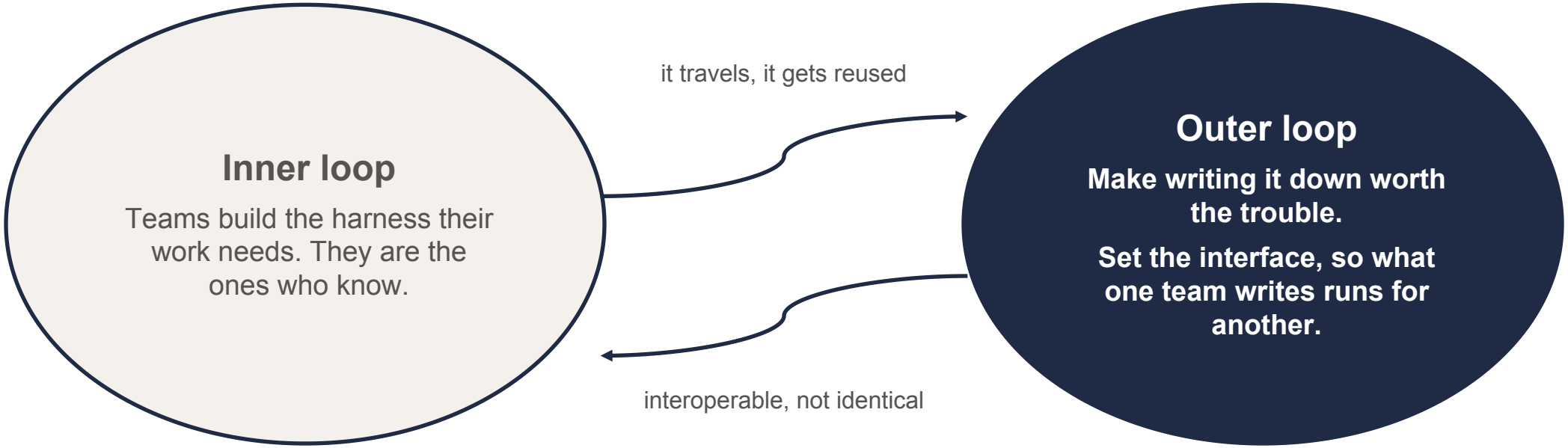


One department writes its protocol, and the organization can run on it and learn from it



Someone has to read what comes back and decide what to improve. That is the outer loop, and it needs an owner.

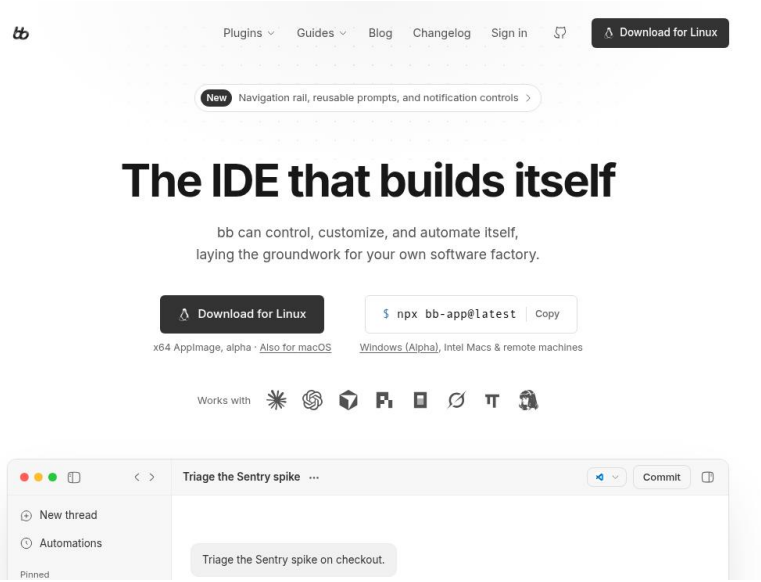
The outer loop is a platform, not a memo

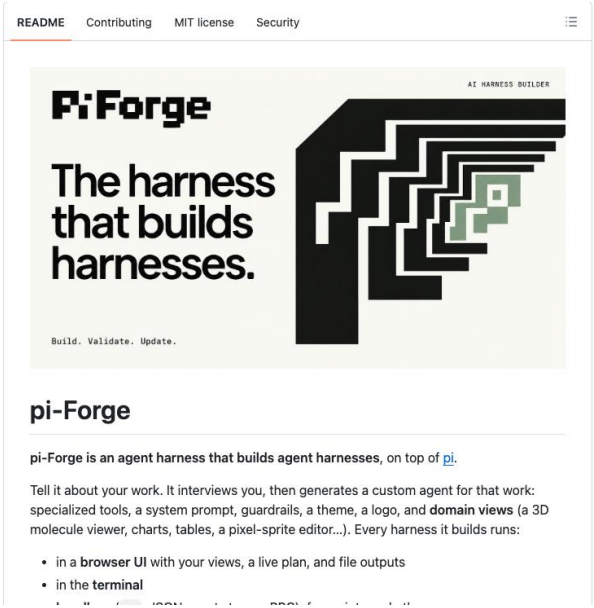


Open source works because publishing is cheap and gets you users. The outer loop reproduces that inside a company.

Stripe's Kai, 2026: teams build their own skills and agents and see their usage. 1,000+ skills from 100+ teams, fewer than ten people run it. stripe.dev, July 2026

Open Source is shaping the edges of what is possible …





bb - The interface: open, and shaped around how a team works.

pi-Forge - The harness: generated from answers to a set of questions.

GOSIM

GOSIM Shenzhen 2026

Thanks!

Igor Schwarzmann · igorschwarzmann.com



GOSIM

GOSIM Shenzhen 2026

Thanks!

Igor Schwarzmann · igorschwarzmann.com

